GRANT GUIDELINES

Prism Fund for LGBTQ+ Arizonans: 2026–2027 Grant Guidelines

Competitive grant · Accepting applications through November 20, 2026

At a glance

Funding: $5,000 to $15,000

Type of support: Project or general operating support

Term: One year, beginning February 1, 2027

Total available: Approximately $140,000

Geographic eligibility: Applications are accepted from organizations serving communities anywhere in Arizona. Proposals serving rural counties receive additional consideration.

Program page: https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/grants/prism-fund-lgbtq/

About the program

The Prism Fund was established in 2009 by LGBTQ+ donors and allies who wanted LGBTQ+ people in rural Arizona to have access to the same support available in the state's largest cities. Today the fund accepts applications from organizations statewide.

The fund supports both established LGBTQ+ organizations and mainstream organizations that are building programs to serve LGBTQ+ community members. Applications are reviewed by a committee of fundholders and community members.

Focus and impact areas

Focus areas: LGBTQ+ Communities.

We welcome proposals that address one or more of the following impact areas:

- Ending new HIV transmissions and supporting people living with HIV
- Affirming physical, behavioral, and gender-affirming health care
- Safe and supportive schools for LGBTQ+ students
- Addressing discrimination in housing, employment, and public services
- Reducing isolation among LGBTQ+ older adults and rural residents

Populations served

- LGBTQ+ youth and young adults
- Transgender, nonbinary, and two-spirit people
- LGBTQ+ older adults

- People living with or at risk of HIV
- LGBTQ+ residents of rural communities

Eligibility

Geographic eligibility

Applications are accepted from organizations serving communities anywhere in Arizona. Proposals serving rural counties receive additional consideration.

Who may apply

- Tax-exempt under Section 501(c)(3), a public agency, a federally recognized tribe or tribal program, or a project with a qualified fiscal sponsor
- Serves LGBTQ+ people in Arizona
- Has an anti-discrimination policy that includes sexual orientation and gender identity
- One application per organization per year

What we do not fund

- Individuals or scholarships
- Religious activities
- Capital campaigns or endowments
- Lobbying or partisan political activity

Funding

$5,000 to $15,000. Project or general operating support.

Key dates

Milestone	Date
Application period opens	Thursday, October 1, 2026
Application deadline	Friday, November 20, 2026, 5:00 p.m. MST
Decision	Applicants notified by January 15, 2027
Grant period	February 1, 2027 – January 31, 2028

How to apply

The Prism Fund uses a single-stage application submitted through the CPCF Grant Portal.

1. **Read the guidelines.** Download the Prism Fund 2026–2027 Grant Guidelines.
2. **Prepare the application.** Use the Community Impact Grant Application Worksheet to draft responses. Prism applicants also answer two fund-specific questions listed in the guidelines.

3. **Submit online.** Submit the application and budget in the CPCF Grant Portal by 5:00 p.m. MST on November 20, 2026.
4. **Decision.** The Prism Fund committee reviews applications in December. Applicants are notified by January 15, 2027.

Application questions

1. How are LGBTQ+ people involved in leading, staffing, or advising your organization?
2. How will you protect the privacy and safety of participants?

Review criteria

- Leadership and involvement of LGBTQ+ people in the organization
- Clarity of need and approach
- Reach into rural or underserved communities
- Feasibility and organizational capacity

Reporting requirements

Grantees submit a Community Impact Story Report at the end of the grant year.

- A short narrative or photo story describing results
- Number of people served
- Permission for public sharing, with care for participant privacy and safety

Due: February 28, 2028.

Templates and supporting documents

- **Community Impact Grant Application Worksheet:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-community-impact-grant-application-worksheet.pdf
- **Grant Project Budget Template:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/templates/cpcf-grant-project-budget-template.pdf
- **Community Impact Story Report Form:** https://hufsa-stack.github.io/cinder-peaks-community-foundation/documents/reporting/cpcf-community-impact-story-report-form.pdf

Questions?

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